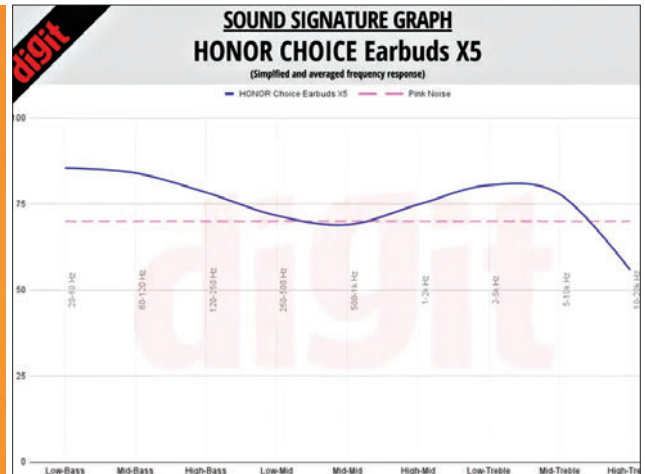




response output was very poor. The bass region is over-amplified while the mids are way below ideal which is causing the auditory masking. The highs pick back up, but the clarity and timbre are below average. Overall, these earbuds only make sense for bass lovers; even so the OnePlus Nord Buds 2 produces bass better while also keeping the mids in check.

As for connectivity, the earbuds come packing Bluetooth version 5.3, so the connection is rock solid. I faced no lag or stutter in my usage at all. However, the connection process takes longer than some of its competitors. The microphone quality is average; calls taken indoors are fine, but when there are disturbances in your surroundings, the HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 doesn't do a great job of suppressing them.

BATTERY LIFE

The HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 are

rated for 35 hours of total battery life, with 9 hours on the earbuds alone. This number is correct when Active Noise Cancellation is turned off; the earbuds lasted about 32 hours (earbuds + case) in total. However, when you turn ANC on, the earbuds themselves last only 6.5 hours and the case can provide about two and a half extra charges.

The charging speeds are not super fast, sadly. Compared to the OnePlus Nord Buds 2, the HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 takes much longer to charge to full. The case tops up to full in about 2 hours, according to our tests.

VERDICT

The HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 is one of the most feature-packed pair of truly wireless earphones that you can get your hands on under ₹3,000. There's Active Noise Cancellation, a fantastic companion app, IP54 dust and splash

resistance, and a Low Latency Gaming Mode. However, the sound quality requires some serious tuning. The bass response is muddy and distorted and the mids are quite muffled. Moreover, the charging speeds are quite slow compared to competitors. The OnePlus Nord Buds 2 are good alternatives to the HONOR CHOICE Earbuds X5 since they have similar features and better sound quality.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Speaker size: 10 mm | Audio codecs: AAC, SBC | App: HONOR AI Space | ANC: Yes, up to 30 dB | Battery life: 9 hours (earbuds), 35 hours (with charging case) | Bluetooth version: 5.3; Bluetooth LE supported | Operating range: 33 feet / 10 m | IP rating: IP54 | Low latency mode: Yes | Weight: 4.26 g (per earbud)

CONTACT

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